

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: Getty Images

Israel and **Lebanon** agreed to implement a ceasefire to halt [fighting](#) between Israeli forces and Hizbullah. The White House said the deal is contingent on the Iran-backed militant group stopping all attacks on Israel. However, a similar agreement last month did little to ease hostilities, and Israel's defence minister added that "fire and ground" operations in southern Lebanon will continue regardless of the latest ceasefire agreement.

America's House of Representatives voted to check **Donald Trump's** ability to continue his **war** in Iran without congressional approval. Four Republicans joined Democrats to pass a [war powers resolution](#), although even if it clears the Senate Mr Trump could still veto it. Nonetheless, the vote is a rare example of Republicans in Congress standing up to the president. Mike Johnson, the House speaker, said it undermined Mr Trump's efforts to end the conflict.

SpaceX unveiled plans to raise \$75bn in an initial public offering. Elon Musk's [rocketry and AI firm](#) said it was seeking to sell 555.6m shares at \$135 each. That would value SpaceX at \$1.77trn. The debut would dwarf Saudi Aramco's, the biggest to date, which raised \$29.4bn in 2019. Anthropic and OpenAI, two more AI firms, are also thought to be preparing [massive IPOs](#).

EU member states unanimously agreed to begin accession talks for **Ukraine** and **Moldova**. Cyprus, which currently holds the presidency of the union, said it marks a “significant milestone” in the two countries’ “European integration path”. The decision came after Hungary dropped its objections to the talks, following the defeat of the pro-Russian Viktor Orban in April’s general election.

Shares in **Broadcom** plunged by more than 10% after it forecast lower-than-expected revenues from AI chips. The American firm said it expected revenues of \$56bn from AI chips for the year ending in October, below the average estimate of \$57.6bn. Broadcom’s shares had surged in recent months, fuelled by excitement over deals it signed with [tech giants](#), including Alphabet and Meta.

Kim Jong Un, **North Korea’s** leader, inspected a “newly commissioned **nuclear** material production plant”, according to state media. South Korea’s army identified it as a uranium-enrichment facility. During the visit, Mr Kim claimed the factory would help expand [his country’s](#) “nuclear forces at an exponential rate”. Despite international pressure, North Korea has rejected any suggestion of nuclear disarmament.

Protesters in **Mexico** attacked the education ministry’s headquarters, escalating a dispute about teachers’ salaries. Claudia Sheinbaum, the president, said she would not “fall into the trap” of cracking down on the protests ahead of [the World Cup](#). A dissident group within the teachers’ union has threatened to hold massive demonstrations on the day of the opening match next week in Mexico City.

Figure of the day: four-fifths, the fraction of all CPUs that Intel and AMD supply for PCs. Find out how Nvidia is [shaking up the laptop market](#).



Photograph: Reuters

Russia's economy rumbles on

The St Petersburg International Economic Forum, Russia's annual showcase for investors, continues on Thursday. "Russia's Davos" takes place at a better moment for the Kremlin than seemed likely a few months ago. At the start of the year, a combination of falling oil prices and ultra-high interest rates led many to believe that Russia was on the verge of recession. More recently, though, firmer oil prices linked to the Iran war have lifted export revenues and eased pressure on public finances. Unemployment remains near record lows, reflecting labour shortages and resilient demand.

Growth is far slower than in the go-go years of 2023 and 2024, with officials recently cutting forecasts. [Ukrainian drone attacks](#) including on a refinery near the get-together on its opening day, limit Russia's ability to benefit from higher oil prices. But the economy remains stronger than expected after Vladimir Putin's invasion of Ukraine. Having confounded predictions of its demise throughout the war, it has done so once again.



Photograph: Reuters

High season for SCOTUS

On Thursday America's Supreme Court will rule on one or more of the 26 cases that need concluding before holidays in July. Its justices have hardly been slacking: recent decisions have facilitated making last minute changes to congressional maps, boosting Republicans' chances of preserving their slim majority in the House of Representatives.

Not all of their rulings have favoured Donald Trump, however; the court upended his signature tariff policy in February. It is also expected to strike down both his bid to withhold automatic citizenship from [babies born to undocumented immigrants or temporary visa-holders](#), and his attempt to sack a Federal Reserve governor on flimsy grounds.

But [Mr Trump stands to triumph](#) in his push for greater executive power. The court will probably scuttle a 91-year-old precedent preventing the president from removing the heads of most administrative agencies. The justices will then wade further into the culture wars. Judgments are due on cases involving gun rights for (occasional) drug users, transgender women in sports and postal ballots.



Photograph: Alamy

Reform UK pushes for a “George Floyd” moment

A murder in Britain has become a political minefield. Henry Nowak was bleeding from multiple knife wounds when police clapped him in handcuffs, hesitating to administer first aid for about a minute. The murderer, Vickrum Digwa, a Sikh, had falsely claimed the white teenager had racially abused him.

Mr Nowak died shortly afterwards, on December 3rd. But the harrowing video footage of his last moments only emerged this week. Nigel Farage and his Reform UK colleagues immediately [seized on it](#) to argue that Britain is subject to “two-tier policing”, which discriminates against white people. Mr Farage, whose populist right-wing party is leading in opinion polls, broadcast an “emergency address” declaring that “white lives matter too”.

Public anger spilled over into the streets of Southampton, where the killing occurred. Similar cases, such as the murder of three young girls at a dance class in 2024, have sparked extended episodes of violence. Rabble-rousing from Mr Farage, who has refused to disavow the protests, could easily encourage another one.

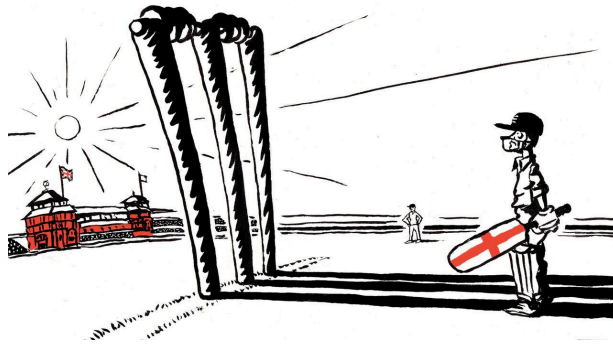


Illustration: David Simonds

“Bazball” returns to cricket

In 2022 the England Cricket Board appointed a pugnacious New Zealander, Brendon McCullum, as coach of its international men’s team. Mr McCullum instituted an ultra-aggressive approach to five-day Test cricket that the media dubbed “Bazball”. His tactics initially stumped opponents, but a humbling in Australia last winter, during which the team was pilloried for poor preparation, worse cricket and excessive drinking, prompted a rethink. The ECB retained Mr McCullum, but he has a brief to encourage more responsible cricket.

The second age of Bazball begins on Thursday at Lord’s, the “Home of Cricket” in London, with a three-match series against New Zealand. Two mainstays of the first era, Zak Crawley and Ollie Pope, are gone. Most intriguingly, England have recalled Ollie Robinson, a bowler who made a brilliant start to his Test career in 2021 but was dropped because of concerns about his commitment. England’s frustrated fans hope that Bazball 2.0 proves to be both sensible and invincible.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Thursday: The recovery programme at Alcoholics Anonymous consists of 12 what?

Wednesday: Which highly common animal group is believed to have descended from dinosaurs?

Failure is not fatal but failure to change might be.

John Wooden